

M2 — reproducibility note

M2_critique_deck.md is a **critique of another group’s M1**, not a new analysis of our own. It therefore produces **no numbers from our own data**, and there is no .qmd to run in this folder.

For M2, reproducibility runs in the opposite direction: *we* clone the reviewed group’s repository and re-run their code, and Slide 2 reports what happened when we did. Running their code and reading their argument are two different passes, and in this review they returned two different kinds of finding:

- **Running the code returned confirmations and one packaging gap.** It ran end to end from raw data, and the funnel, the group sizes, the death count and both headline contrasts regenerated and match their deck. The check we ran deliberately — whether the survey design is built on the full frame and then subsetting, rather than the rows being filtered before the design is created — came back clean, and Slide 2 reports it as clean. Their figures are substituted at build time rather than typed, so the deck cannot carry a mistyped number. It can still carry a stale one: if the data change and the result objects are not re-emitted, deck and code disagree. That is why we re-ran the increments before comparing. The one defect this pass found is a packaging one: their README does not list every package the pipeline loads, so a clean install stops twice.
- **Reading the argument returned both substantive objections.** Objection 1 (Slide 3): the paper’s published Table 2 is used as corroboration without an interval, and their own detail note concedes that interval cannot be recovered. Objection 2 (Slide 4): the TyG item on their “what would change our mind” list cannot settle the locked contrast, because that sensitivity is estimated against Group I whatever weights are applied. Neither surfaced from the pipeline run: both came from reading their deck, their detail notes and the paper’s own table.

A good critique needs both passes. Running the code without reading the argument tells you that the pipeline executes, not whether it answers the question; reading the argument without running the code leaves you with only what the authors chose to show you.

The numbers quoted in the deck *about the demonstration paper* — the funnel, group sizes, HRs, interaction p-values — are reproduced by the .qmd files in the P1–P5 and M1 subfolders of this directory; the funnel counts on Slide 5 are P1’s.